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Sardar Patel Institute of Technology (SPIT)
Academic Year 2026–27

Student Clubs and Societies Handbook

Office of the Dean of Student Affairs (Student Activities Cell)

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This handbook sets out how student clubs, societies and professional chapters are formed, recognised, governed and funded at Sardar Patel Institute of Technology, and how their events are approved and conducted.

1.2 It applies to every recognised student body (referred to in this handbook as a "club") and to any group of students that wishes to use the institute's name, logo, premises or funds for an activity.

1.3 This version (2.0) replaces the Student Clubs and Societies Handbook, Version 1.3 (SPIT-CA-CLB-2023-01). The principal changes are listed in Section 14.

1.4 Misconduct by a club member or office bearer is dealt with under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01). Action against a club as a body is taken under Section 13 of this handbook.

2. Governance Structure

2.1 **Dean of Student Affairs (DSA).** The DSA has overall responsibility for student activities, approves club recognition, major events and budgets, and chairs the Student Activities Council.

2.2 **Student Activities Cell (SAC).** The SAC is the administrative office under the DSA, located in Room A-104, Administrative Block. It processes club registrations, event proposals, venue bookings, reimbursements and activity-point records. It is staffed by the Student Activities Coordinator (a faculty member) and an office assistant.

2.3 **Student Activities Council.** The Council consists of the DSA (Chairperson), the Student Activities Coordinator (Member-Secretary), the faculty conveners of the five club categories, the Accounts Officer, the General Secretary of the Student Council and the Technical, Cultural and Sports Secretaries of the Student Council. It meets in the first week of every month during the semester.

2.4 **Student Council.** The Student Council is the elected student body of the institute. Its General Secretary, Cultural Secretary, Technical Secretary, Sports Secretary and Ladies' Representative coordinate the annual festivals and inter-club activities.

3. Categories of Clubs

3.1 Every club is placed in one of five categories. Each category has a faculty convener appointed by the DSA.

Category	Examples of activities	Typical clubs (synthetic)
Technical	Coding, robotics, electronics, AI/ML, cybersecurity, hackathons	Coding Club, Robotics and Automation Society, AI Research Circle
Professional chapters	Student branches of professional bodies	IEEE Student Branch, ACM Student Chapter, CSI Student Branch
Cultural	Music, dance, drama, fine arts, photography, literature, debate	Music Society, Dramatics Club, Literary and Debating Society
Sports and fitness	Inter-collegiate teams, fitness, adventure	Cricket Club, Basketball Club, Chess Club, Trekking Club
Social and outreach	Community service, environment, entrepreneurship, wellness	Rotaract Club, Green Campus Initiative, Entrepreneurship Cell, NSS Unit

3.2 The NSS (National Service Scheme) unit and the Entrepreneurship Cell follow these rules for events and funds, but their membership and activities are also governed by the guidelines of their respective parent schemes.

4. Forming and Recognising a New Club

4.1 A proposal for a new club may be submitted by any group of current students, through the "Club Registration" form on the Student Portal (portal.spit.example), between 1 July and 31 August (for odd-semester recognition) or between 1 December and 15 January (for even-semester recognition).

4.2 A proposal must include:

- the club's name, category and objectives;
- a list of at least **25 founding members** from at least **two different years of study**, with their consent;
- the names of at least three proposed interim office bearers (President, Secretary and Treasurer);
- the written consent of a full-time faculty member to act as Faculty Advisor;
- a draft constitution based on the model club constitution (Form C-1) available on the Student Portal;
- an activity plan for the first semester with at least three proposed events.

4.3 A proposal will not be accepted if the objectives of the proposed club substantially duplicate those of an existing recognised club; the founders will be advised to join or form a wing of the existing club.

4.4 The SAC scrutinises the proposal within 10 working days and places it before the Student Activities Council. If the Council recommends it, the DSA grants **provisional recognition for one semester**. Full recognition is granted at the end of that semester if the club has conducted at least two events and submitted its semester report.

4.5 A provisionally recognised club may use the institute's name and premises but is not eligible for an annual grant. It may apply for event-specific support of up to ₹15,000 in its first semester.

5. Annual Renewal

5.1 Every recognised club must renew its recognition each academic year by **31 August 2026**, through the "Club Renewal" form on the Student Portal, by submitting:

- the list of current members (minimum 25) and office bearers for 2026–27;
- the annual report and statement of accounts for 2025–26, countersigned by the Faculty Advisor;
- the activity plan and budget request for 2026–27.

5.2 A club that does not renew by the deadline is placed in "inactive" status: it cannot book venues, conduct events or receive funds. A club that remains inactive until 31 January 2027 is derecognised.

5.3 A club that has conducted fewer than three events in the previous academic year will be renewed on probation for one semester.

6. Faculty Advisor

6.1 Each club must have a Faculty Advisor who is a full-time faculty member of the institute. A faculty member may advise no more than two clubs at a time.

6.2 The Faculty Advisor:

- approves every event proposal and expense of the club before it is submitted to the SAC;
- is present, or nominates another faculty member to be present, at every event held on campus after 18:00 and at every off-campus event;
- countersigns the club's accounts and semester reports;
- reports any misconduct or safety concern to the DSA.

6.3 If the Faculty Advisor leaves the institute or withdraws, the club must nominate a new Faculty Advisor within 30 days; until then, the faculty convener of the category acts as Faculty Advisor.

7. Office Bearers: Eligibility, Selection and Tenure

7.1 Each club must have at least the following office bearers: President, Vice-President, General Secretary, Treasurer and Events Head. Clubs with more than 100 members may add up to four more posts (for example, Technical Head, Public Relations Head, Design Head).

7.2 **Eligibility.** A student is eligible to hold office in a club only if the student:

- is a full-time student who will be in the second, third or final year (UG) or second year (PG) during the tenure;
- has a CGPA of **6.00 or above** up to the most recent declared semester;
- has no active backlog (failed course not yet cleared) at the time of selection;
- is not under any Category B or Category C penalty under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules, and has not been found guilty of ragging at any time;
- has not appeared in the attendance defaulter list in the most recent semester, as defined in the institute's Attendance Policy for 2026–27.

7.3 **Limit on posts.** A student may hold the post of President, General Secretary or Treasurer in only one club at a time, and may hold not more than two office-bearer posts in total across all clubs. Members of the Student Council executive may not be Presidents of clubs.

7.4 **Selection.** Office bearers for the next academic year are selected between **1 March and 15 April 2027**, by election among the club's registered members or by interview by an outgoing core committee and the Faculty Advisor, as stated in the club's constitution. Results must be submitted to the SAC by 30 April 2027.

7.5 **Tenure.** The tenure of office bearers runs from 1 May to 30 April. No student may hold the post of President of the same club for more than one tenure.

7.6 **Removal.** An office bearer may be removed by the DSA on the recommendation of the Faculty Advisor for misconduct, misuse of funds or failure to perform duties, after the office bearer has been given an opportunity to respond in writing within 5 working days.

8. Events: Approval and Conduct

8.1 **Event proposal.** Every event, whether on or off campus, must be approved before it is announced publicly. Proposals are submitted on the "Event Proposal" form on the Student Portal, with the Faculty Advisor's approval, within the lead times below.

Event type	Minimum lead time before the event	Approving authority
Internal event (participants only from SPIT, up to 200 people, no external speakers)	7 working days	Student Activities Coordinator
Event with external speakers or external participants, or more than 200 people	15 working days	Dean of Student Affairs
Event with sponsorship, ticket sales or registration fees	15 working days	Dean of Student Affairs, with Accounts Officer's review
Off-campus event, industrial visit, trek or outstation competition	21 working days	Dean of Student Affairs and Director
Intercollegiate festival or event with more than 1,000 people	45 working days	Director

8.2 **Event timings.** Events on campus may be held between 08:00 and 21:00. With the DSA's approval, an event may continue until **22:00**. No event may continue after 22:00 under any circumstances. Hostel residents must return to their blocks by 22:30 as required by the Hostel Rules and Regulations (SPIT-CA-HST-2026-01).

8.3 **Events during examinations.** No club event may be held during the end-semester examination period or the seven calendar days immediately preceding it, as notified in the Academic Calendar.

8.4 **Venue booking.** Venues are booked through the "Venue Booking" module of the Student Portal only after event approval. Venues available for club events are:

Venue	Capacity	Booking notes
Main Auditorium	600	Book at least 10 working days in advance; requires an audio-visual technician (charged to the event budget at ₹1,500 per day)
Seminar Hall 1 and Seminar Hall 2	150 each	Book at least 5 working days in advance
Classrooms (Academic Block)	60 – 90	After 16:30 on working days and on Saturdays only
Open-Air Amphitheatre	400	Not available during monsoon (15 June – 30 September)
Sports Ground and Indoor Sports Hall	As applicable	Booked through the Physical Education Department

8.5 **Students' academic commitments.** Event participation does not exempt students from classes, laboratory sessions or examinations. Requests for on-duty (OD) status for students representing the institute at external competitions are processed as provided in the Attendance

Policy for 2026–27, on the recommendation of the Faculty Advisor and the DSA.

8.6 **Safety.** For any event with more than 200 people, the club must submit a crowd management and safety plan with the proposal, including entry control, first aid arrangements and emergency exits. For off-campus events, every participating student must submit a consent form signed by a parent or guardian, and at least one faculty member must accompany every 30 students.

8.7 **Event report.** Within 7 working days after the event, the club must upload an event report to the Student Portal with the number of participants, photographs, feedback summary and a statement of expenses. Clubs that do not submit reports are not permitted to propose further events until the report is submitted.

9. Finances

9.1 **Sources of funds.** A club's funds may come only from (a) the annual grant from the institute's student activities fund, (b) event-specific grants, (c) sponsorship approved under Section 9.6, and (d) registration fees for events approved under Section 8.1. Clubs may not collect membership fees exceeding ₹200 per member per year.

9.2 **Annual grant.** Annual grants for 2026–27 are allotted by the Student Activities Council by 15 September 2026, based on the club's previous year's activity and budget request. The ceilings are:

Club category	Maximum annual grant per club (2026–27)
Technical	₹1,50,000
Professional chapters	₹1,00,000
Cultural	₹1,20,000
Sports and fitness	₹1,00,000 (excluding equipment purchased centrally by the Physical Education Department)
Social and outreach	₹75,000

9.3 **No cash holding.** Clubs may not open bank accounts in the club's name or hold cash. All institute funds are spent through the Accounts Section. Registration fees and sponsorship money must be collected only through the payment link generated by the Accounts Section on the Student Portal.

9.4 **Advance and reimbursement.** Expenses can be met either (a) by an advance of up to ₹25,000 per event, which must be settled with bills within 15 working days after the event, or (b) by reimbursement of expenses paid by a student, claimed within **30 days** of the event with original GST invoices and the Faculty Advisor's approval. Claims submitted after 30 days are not entertained. Reimbursements are credited to the student's bank account registered on the Student Portal within 21 working days of a complete claim.

9.5 **Purchases.** Purchases above ₹10,000 from a single vendor require three quotations. Purchases above ₹50,000 are made by the Purchase Section on behalf of the club. Equipment purchased from club funds is institute property and is recorded in the club's stock register held by the SAC.

9.6 **Sponsorship.** A club may obtain sponsorship only after the DSA approves the sponsor and the sponsorship terms. Sponsorship agreements are signed by the Registrar on behalf of the institute, not by students. Sponsorship from tobacco, alcohol, gambling or betting companies, or from political parties, is not permitted. Sponsors may not be promised access to students' personal data.

9.7 **Audit.** The Accounts Section audits each club's accounts at the end of the academic year. Any unexplained shortfall is recovered from the office bearers responsible, and misappropriation of funds is a Category C offence under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules.

10. Activity Points and Recognition of Participation

10.1 Students earn activity points for participation in club activities, recorded on the Student Portal by the SAC on the basis of event reports. Activity points are shown on the student's co-curricular transcript issued with the final grade card.

Activity	Activity points
Participation in an approved institute-level event (minimum 3 hours)	2 per event (maximum 10 per semester)
Organising team member for an approved event	5 per event
Office bearer for a full tenure	15 (President, General Secretary, Treasurer); 10 (other posts)
Winning a prize at an intercollegiate event (state level)	10
Winning a prize at a national or international event	20
NSS or community service (per 20 hours of verified service)	5

10.2 Every UG student must earn at least **100 activity points** during the programme (at least 50 points for students admitted directly to the second year). The academic consequences of not meeting the requirement are governed by the institute's academic regulations.

10.3 The DSA presents the annual Student Activity Awards in March, including Best Club (one per category), Best Event of the Year and Outstanding Office Bearer.

11. Annual Festivals (Synthetic)

11.1 The Student Council organises two institute festivals each year with the participation of all clubs:

Festival	Type	Indicative dates for 2026–27	Organising body
Spectra	Technical festival	15 – 17 January 2027	Student Council (Technical Secretary) with technical clubs and professional chapters
Rangotsav	Cultural festival	18 – 20 February 2027	Student Council (Cultural Secretary) with cultural clubs

11.2 Clubs must submit proposals for festival events to the respective Student Council secretary by 30 November 2026 (Spectra) and 15 December 2026 (Rangotsav).

12. Communication, Branding and Social Media

12.1 Clubs may use the institute name and logo only in the approved format provided by the SAC and only for approved activities. Posters and social media posts announcing events must carry the event approval number.

12.2 Club social media accounts must list the Faculty Advisor and the SAC as account administrators, and login credentials must be handed over to the new office bearers at the end of each tenure.

12.3 Clubs must not post content that is defamatory, obscene, communal or political in nature, or that shares the personal information of any student without consent.

13. Suspension and Derecognition of a Club

13.1 The DSA may suspend the activities of a club for up to one semester, after giving the club's office bearers an opportunity to respond, for any of the following:

- conducting an event without approval or violating the conditions of approval;
- failure to submit event reports or accounts;

- collection of money outside the approved payment system;
- misuse of the institute's name, logo or social media;
- an incident at a club event involving ragging, harassment, alcohol or drugs, or endangering safety.

13.2 The Director may derecognise a club on the recommendation of the Student Activities Council for repeated or serious violations. A derecognised club may not be re-registered under the same or a similar name for two academic years.

13.3 A club may appeal against suspension or derecognition to the Director within 10 working days of the decision. The Director's decision is final.

13.4 Action against a club does not prevent separate disciplinary action against individual students under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules.

14. Changes from the Previous Version

14.1 This version (2.0) supersedes SPIT-CA-CLB-2023-01 (Version 1.3). The principal changes are:

Provision	Previous version 1.3 (2023)	This version 2.0 (2026–27)
Minimum founding members for a new club	15	25, from at least two years of study
Recognition of new clubs	Full recognition on approval	Provisional recognition for one semester, then full recognition
Minimum CGPA for office bearers	6.50	6.00, with no active backlog
Latest event end time	21:00 (no extension)	21:00, extendable to 22:00 with DSA approval
Lead time for events with external participants	10 working days	15 working days
Reimbursement claim period	60 days	30 days, credited within 21 working days
Maximum advance per event	₹15,000	₹25,000
Annual grant ceiling (Technical)	₹1,00,000	₹1,50,000
Activity points	Not recorded	Recorded on the Student Portal; 100 points required for UG students
Club renewal deadline	30 September	31 August

15. Contact

Purpose	Contact
Club registration, renewal, event approvals	Student Activities Cell, Room A-104, Administrative Block; studentactivities@spit.example; extension 2101
Venue booking	Student Activities Cell; extension 2102
Reimbursements and advances	Accounts Section (Student Activities desk), Administrative Block; extension 2125
Dean of Student Affairs	Office of the DSA, Room A-102, Administrative Block; dsa@spit.example; extension 2100
Student Council	studentcouncil@spit.example

15.1 A complaint about the handling of a club matter by the SAC that is not resolved within 7 working days may be raised under the Student Grievance Redressal Policy (SPIT-CA-GRV-2026-01).